

t

▽ The “t” sound

This consonant is represented by the graphemes *bt, t, th, tt, and ed*.

doubt tiger thyme cattle jumped

v

▷ The “v” sound

This consonant is represented by the graphemes *f and v*.

of dove

w

▷ The “w” sound

This consonant is represented by the graphemes *w, wh, and u*.

walrus whale penguin

y

▷ The “y” sound

This consonant is represented by the graphemes *i and y*.

onion yak

z

▽ The “z” sound

This consonant is represented by the graphemes *s, ss, x, z, and zz*.

please scissors xylophone zebra buzz

Digraphs

A digraph is a single sound that is made by combining two letters. For example, the word *shining* begins with the digraph “sh” and is represented by the grapheme *sh*. This digraph can appear in other words, such as *action*, but in this case it is written as *ti*.

Digraph	Grapheme	Examples
ch	ch, t, tch	chicken, nature, hatch
ng	n (before k), ng	monkey, hatchling
sh	ce, ch, ci, sh, ss, ti	ocean, chef, special, sheep, mission, motion
th (voiceless)	th	sloth
th (voiced)	th	feather
zh	ge, s	beige, vision

REAL WORLD

NATO phonetic alphabet

The NATO phonetic alphabet is used to avoid confusion when spelling words verbally. Each word is spoken in place of the name of the letter. Radio broadcasters in the military and aviation industries use this alphabet.

A	Alpha	N	November
B	Bravo	O	Oscar
C	Charlie	P	Papa
D	Delta	Q	Quebec
E	Echo	R	Romeo
F	Foxtrot	S	Sierra
G	Golf	T	Tango
H	Hotel	U	Uniform
I	India	V	Victor
J	Juliet	W	Whiskey
K	Kilo	X	X-ray
L	Lima	Y	Yankee
M	Mike	Z	Zulu

Blends

Consonant blends are two or more consonants that join together. They can appear at the beginning or end of a word. Like digraphs, they are never separated, but the individual sound that is represented by each letter is heard. For example, the word *bright* begins with the blend *br*, and the individual letters—*b* and *r*—are clearly heard.

Blend	Examples	Blend	Examples
bl	block	pl	plum
br	bread	pr	pretzel
cl	clam	pt	adapt
cr	cracker	sc	scallop
ct	perfect	sch	school
dr	drink	scr	scrape
fl	floor	sk	skeleton
fr	fruit	sk	whisk
ft	sift	sl	slither
gl	glaze	sm	smoke
gr	grapefruit	sn	snack
lb	bulb	sp	spaghetti
ld	mild	sp	crisp
lf	self	sph	sphere
lk	milk	spl	splatter
lm	elm	spr	sprinkle
ln	kiln	squ	squid
lp	pulp	st	steak
lt	malt	st	toast
mp	chomp	str	strawberry
nd	grind	sw	sweet
nk	drink	tr	trout
nt	mint	tw	twin